

Benjamin S. Manning

CONTACT	bmanning (at) mit.edu ◇ benjaminmanning.com	
EDUCATION	Massachusetts Institute of Technology	
	Ph.D. Management Science, Information Technology	2022 - Present
	Committee: <i>John Horton (Chair), Christopher Avery, Colin Camerer</i>	
	S.M. Management Research	2024
	Harvard University	
	M.P.P. Economic & Social Policy	2021
	Washington University in St. Louis	
	B.A. Mathematics (College Honors)	2017
GRANTS (\$488,325)	Google Cloud Research Credits Grant (\$5,000; w/ Alex Moehring)	2026
	Schmidt Sciences AI at Work Award (\$193,325)	2025
	Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000)	2025
	MIT GenAI Impact Consortium & OpenAI (\$180,000; w/ John J. Horton)	2025
	Schmidt Sciences Grant Proposal Award (\$10,000)	2025
	Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000)	2024
AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS	EC '26 Exemplary Paper Award	2026
	WISE Best Paper Award	2025
	Harvard Distinction in Student Teaching Award	2025
	Becker Friedman Institute Price Theory Summer Camp	2025
	Kosciuszko Foundation Tuition Scholarship (\$3,500)	2022
	Kosciuszko Foundation Tuition Scholarship (\$3,000)	2019
JOB MARKET PAPER	General Social Agents	
	(Benjamin S. Manning ¹ & John J. Horton)	
	Revise & Resubmit at <i>Econometrica</i>	
	• WISE 2025 Best Paper Award • Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '26)</i> • Media: Marginal Revolution	
WORKING PAPERS	Automated Social Science: Language Models as Scientist and Subjects	
	(Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Kehang Zhu ¹ , & John J. Horton)	
	Reject & Resubmit at <i>The Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>	
	• EC '26 Exemplary Paper Award (one of six) • Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '26)</i> • Media: Marginal Revolution	
	Modeling Human Behavior with Type Vectors Using AI	
	(Matthew O. Jackson ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Yutong Xie ¹ , Walter Yuan, & Qiaozhu Mei)	
	<i>Under Review</i>	
	Self-Supervised Preference Learning for Multimodal Foundation Models	
	(Akshata Tiwari ¹ , Jillian Ross, Benjamin S. Manning , & Andrew Lo)	
	<i>Under Review</i>	

¹Indicates first author or co-first author

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS	AI Agents as Flexible Commitment Devices: Evidence from the Field (Benjamin S. Manning ¹ & Alex Moehring ¹)
	Taste-as-Program: Scalable Preference Elicitation with AI (Gili Rusak ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , & John J. Horton)
	Mass In Silico Replication of Social Science Experiments (Jacob Snyder ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , John J. Horton ¹ , & Abhishek Nagaraj ¹)
	What Causes Price Bubbles? Theory and Evidence from Simulations and the Lab (Cady Ngo ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Christopher Avery ¹ , & Colin Camerer ¹)
PEER- REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS	Large Language Models as Simulated Economic Agents: What Can We Learn from Homo Silicus? (John J. Horton ¹ , Apostolos Filippas ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹) <i>The Review of Economics and Statistics</i> , Conditionally Accepted Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '24)</i>
	Prompt Adaptation as a Dynamic Complement in Generative AI Systems (Eaman Jahani ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning, Joe Zhang, Hong-Yi TuYe, Mohammed Alsobay, Christos Nicolaides, Siddharth Suri, & David Holtz) <i>Information Systems Research</i> , 2026 Media: Marginal Revolution, MIT Ideas Made to Matter, Columbia Business School Insights
	National Megastudy Shows that Email Nudges to Elementary School Teachers Boost Student Math Achievement, Particularly When Personalized (Angela Duckworth ¹ , Katherine Milkman, ... Benjamin S. Manning, ..., & 26 others) <i>Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences</i> , 2025
	Effect Size Magnification: No Variable is as Important as the One You're Thinking About—While You're Thinking About It (Linnea Gandhi ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning, & Angela Duckworth) <i>Current Directions in Psychological Science</i> , 2024 - Top 10 most downloaded Association for Psychological Science (APS) journal articles in 2024 - Media: Under the Cortex
REFEREED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS	Strategic Tradeoffs Between Humans and AI in Multi-Agent Bargaining (Crystal Qian ¹ , Kehang Zhu ¹ , John J. Horton, Benjamin S. Manning, Vivian Tsai, James Wexler, & Nithum Thain) <i>ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI)</i> , 2026
BOOK CHAPTERS	The Coasean Singularity? Demand, Supply, and Market Design with AI Agents (Peyman Shahidi ¹ , Gili Rusak ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Andrey Fradkin ¹ , & John J. Horton ¹) Forthcoming in <i>The Economics of Transformative AI</i> Media: Marginal Revolution, MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy
TEACHING	<i>BUSN 38802</i> : Managerial Decision Making; TA for Richard Thaler , University of Chicago—Booth London Campus, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.7/5.0)

API-101Z: Markets and Failures; **TA for Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.6/5.0)

API-101Z: Markets and Failures; **TA for Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2023 (Rating: 4.3/5.0)

GUEST
LECTURES

API-101Z: Markets and Failures; **Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2025

QSTBA 830: Business Experimentation and Causal Methods; **Andrey Fradkin**—Boston University, Spring 2025

AFFILIATIONS

MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy, Heterodox Academy

REFEREEING

Economics: *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Experimental Economics*, *Southern Economic Journal*

General Interest: *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences Nexus*

Management: *Management Science*, *Manufacturing and Service Operations Management (MSOM)*, *International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)*

Computer Science: *Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, *ACM Conference on Collective Intelligence*

Sociology: *Sociological Science*

Program Committees: *ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (2026)*, *The Business Implications of Generative AI (BIG.AI) (2026)*, *Workshop on Agent Behavior at the Conference on Language Modeling (COLM) (2026)*, *Conference on Digital Experimentation (CODE) (2023)*

Grants: *J-PAL Project AI Evidence*

INVITED
SEMINARS

2026 / 2027 (Includes scheduled talks): University of North Dakota (Real Estate, Economics & Finance); LSE (Centre for Philosophy of Natural and Social Science); University of Connecticut (Operations & Information Management); Chapman University (Business and Economics)

2025: Dartmouth College (Economics); Instacart Economics Team

2024: Instacart Economics Team

CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS

2026 / 2027 (Includes scheduled talks): Zurich Workshop on Economics and Psychology; Informs Annual Meeting; Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST); AI in Social Science Conference (UChicago); AI and Economics Summer Conference (UChicago); NBER AI and Economic Measurement; Columbia Management, Analytics, and Data Conference; Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; Digital Economy Workshop (Athens); AEA Annual Meeting.

2025: Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE); North American Meeting of the Economic Science Association (ESA); KOF ETH Zurich and IZA Workshop: Matching Workers and Jobs Online; Machine Learning in Economics Summer Conference (UChicago); Academy of Management (AOM) Annual Meeting; Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; NBER/CEME Decentralization and AI; Khipu Latin American Meeting in AI; AEA Annual Meeting.

2024: National Association for Business Economics (NABE); Econometric Society Conference on Economics and AI and ML; ZEW Conference on the Economics of ICT; International Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics; Statistical Conference in

E-Commerce Research (SCECR); Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; Microsoft Research AI, Cognition, and the Economy Workshop; Measuring Development: AI, the Next Generation at the World Bank.

2023: MIT Computer Science and AI Lab (CSAIL) (FutureTech)

EMPLOYMENT	University of Pennsylvania	2021 - 2022
	Research Assistant for Angela Duckworth	
	University of Chicago	2020 - 2022
	Research Assistant for Jon Rogowski	
	Dartmouth College	2018 - 2019
	Research Assistant for Sydney Finkelstein	
	Phetpittayakom School	2017 - 2018
	High School Math Teacher in Thailand	
	Optiver US LLC	2016
	Execution Trading Intern	